Operation Long Road

F/A-18C Hornet · 1–2 players · Caucasus · midday interdiction, SEAD leads · cold start and recovery aboard CVN-74

Column moves	**12:10:00 local** / 08:10:00Z	**Target**	Stalled column, 10 vehicles, coast road
SEAD	COLT on your call · a HARM hit = 90 s window	**Weapons**	HARM, GBU-12, Mk-20 Rockeye
Control	PONTIAC (MQ-9), Type 3	**Threats**	SA-6, SA-8, 2× ZSU-23-4, MiG-29s
Mother	CVN-74 · 127.5 · TACAN 74X · ICLS 11	**Support**	COLT (yours), PONTIAC, ARCO, CHEVY, MAGIC

Situation

Narrow Gate worked, and CAG kept his word. You planned it, and now you plan and lead the follow-up, with COLT, a pair of HARM-armed Hornets, assigned to your package.

The lead battalion's tanks, fuel and ammunition are burning at the Ochamchire depot, and the brigade's main body is stuck behind it on the coast road, nose to tail, waiting for fuel that isn't coming. PONTIAC is watching the column: two T-72s, three BMP-2s, three fuel trucks and two ammunition trucks, with an SA-8 and two ZSU-23-4s riding along. The brigade has set up its own SA-6 battery 2.2 nm north-east of the column to cover it.

They won't wait forever. At about **12:10** the brigade gives up on the fuel and turns inland for the wooded hills 4.5 nm away. Anything that reaches the trees is gone.

Mission

Destroy the column on the coast road before it reaches cover.

SEAD leads

The SA-6 covers the column, and PONTIAC won't clear an attack on the column while the SA-6 can shoot. Each HARM that hits the Straight Flush radar puts it off the air for 90 seconds, and that is your window to get bombs on the column. Kill the radar outright, with a HARM or a GBU-12 on PONTIAC's laser, and the SA-6 is finished for good.

COLT holds over the water, outside SA-6 reach, until you push it from the F10 menu. From its hold it is about 3 minutes to its HARM shots, so time the push to arrive as the HARMs land. Enfield 1-1 carries two backup HARMs. Enfield 1-2 carries cluster bombs for the column.

Rockeye needs a lower release than the GBU-12s, and below about 10,000 ft you are inside the reach of the ZSUs and the SA-8.

Threats

- **SA-6** (Straight Flush and four launchers) reaches above 20,000 ft.
- **SA-8** with the column reaches about 5.5 nm in DCS. It is radar guided, so HARMs work on it too.
- **Two ZSU-23-4s** ride in the column.
- **Two MiG-29s** launch from Gudauta at about 11:50. MAGIC will commit CHEVY when they do, and you can ask for cover over the column from the F10 menu. If CHEVY is out of missiles, short of fuel, down to one jet or lost, Mother launches her alert-5, UZI, two more Hornets: about 12 minutes to station, and only one section.

What happens next

This is the last mission on this branch of the campaign.

Result	Needs	What it means
Success	7 or more of the 10 vehicles destroyed	The brigade's main body is wrecked on the coast road. The advance on the Inguri is over
Partial	4 to 6 destroyed	The survivors reach the hills. The advance is delayed, not stopped
Failure	3 or fewer	Most of the column reaches cover, and the brigade will try again
Bonus	SA-6 radar destroyed	Reported in the summary
A jet lost	Any result	If the pilot ejected over land, also fly **Operation_Sandy_Lift_Long_Road.miz**

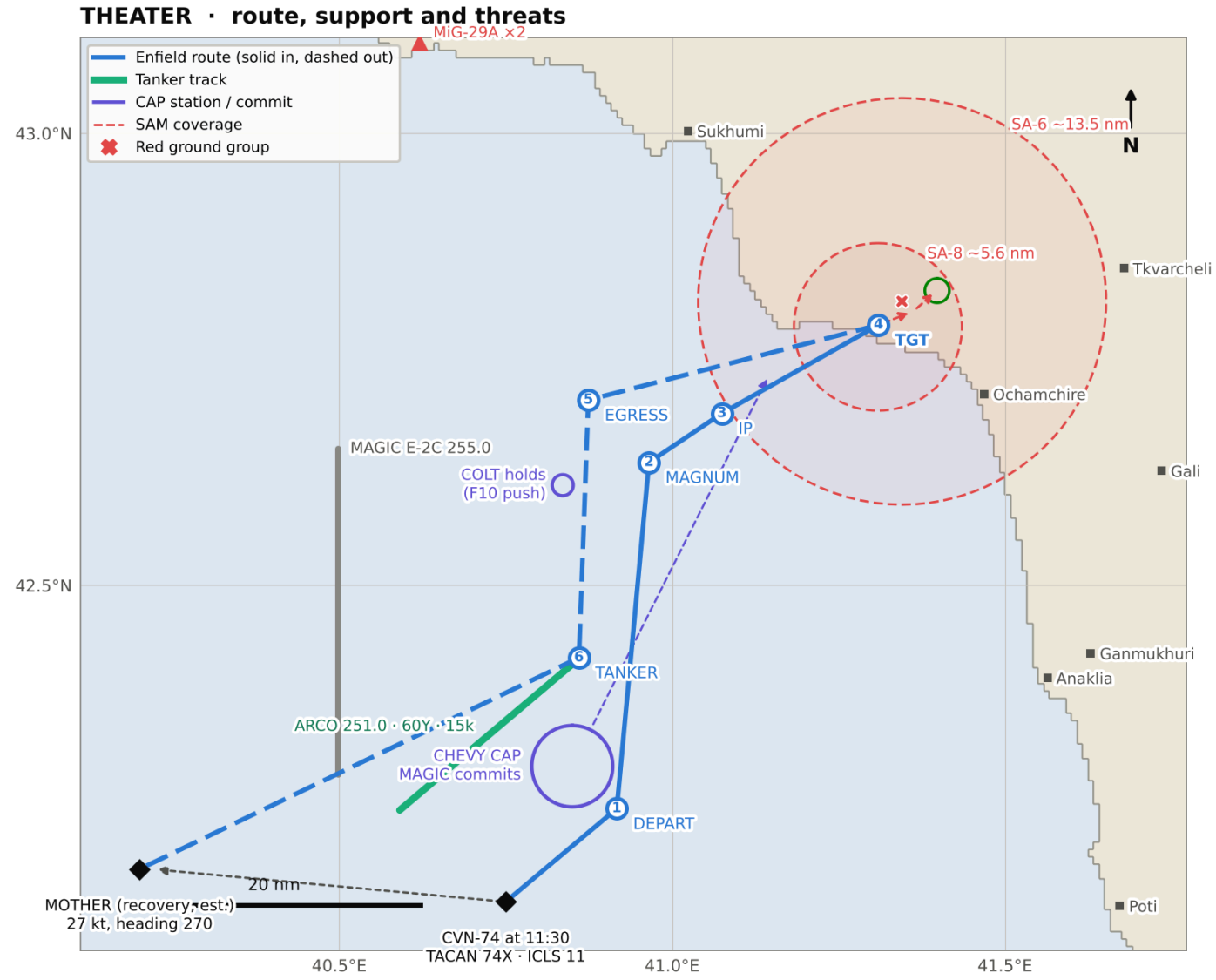
Secondary objective, **clean recovery**: every jet that launches traps aboard Mother with at least about 2,000 lb of fuel, and nobody is lost.

1 or 2 players, cold start on the deck. Enfield 1-1 is flyable in single player.

Key times

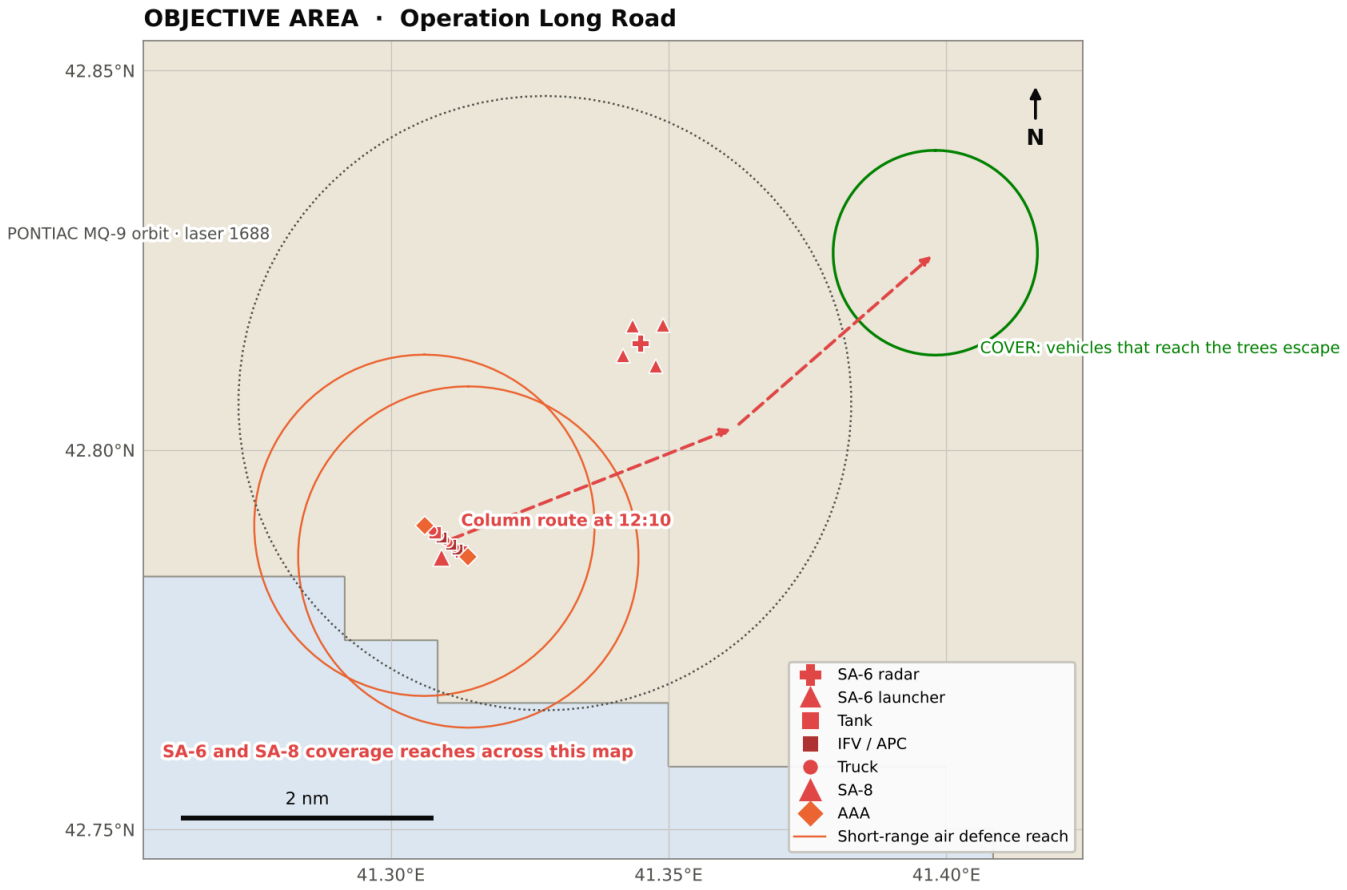
Event	Local
Mission start, cold on the deck	11:30
Red MiG-29 pair launches	11:50
PONTIAC: column crews mounting up	12:00
Column moves for the hills	**12:10**
Last vehicle in cover, if untouched (estimate)	12:27

MAP 1



Coastline is approximate (about 1 km resolution). Courses are true. MOTHER is the carrier's estimated position at recovery. She steams west at 27 kt, so trust TACAN 74X over the waypoint.

MAP 2



Control: SEAD leads (Type 3, PONTIAC)

Step	You (F10)	Response
1	Pontiac: target update	Column status, the lead vehicle and the Straight Flush coordinates
2	PUSH COLT; the lead's own HARMs from MAGNUM as backup	COLT reaches its Magnum point about 3 minutes after the push. A hit puts the SA-6 off the air for 90 s
3	IN on SA-6 radar (DEAD), laser on the Straight Flush	Always cleared. Radar destroyed means the SA-6 is out for good
4	IN on column	CLEARED HOT only while the SA-6 is suppressed or dead, otherwise ABORT
5	Laser on column, or terminate	The spot works along the column; once it is moving, the vehicle nearest cover
6	OFF	BDA: impacts, closest miss, column destroyed or escaped, SA-6 status

A clearance lasts 2 minutes. Releases without clearance, and attacks on the column while the SA-6 is live, are flagged in the summary.

Times and route

The column moves at **12:10:00 local / 08:10:00Z**, 40 minutes after mission start. The MiG-29s launch at about 11:50.

WP	Name	Coordinates	Alt	Leg	Course
0	CVN-74 (deck)	N 42°09.000′ E 040°45.000′	deck		
1	DEPART	N 42°15.184′ E 040°55.011′	5,000 ft	9.7 nm	050°
2	MAGNUM	N 42°38.161′ E 040°57.917′	22,000 ft	23.1 nm	005°
3	IP	N 42°41.414′ E 041°04.488′	20,000 ft	5.8 nm	056°
4	TGT	N 42°47.280′ E 041°18.600′	20,000 ft	11.9 nm	060°
5	EGRESS	N 42°42.300′ E 040°52.450′	20,000 ft	19.9 nm	256°
6	TANKER	N 42°25.200′ E 040°51.600′	15,000 ft	17.1 nm	182°
7	MOTHER (land)	N 42°11.163′ E 040°11.990′	deck	32.5 nm	245°

MAGNUM (waypoint 2) is the HARM launch point, about 20 nm from the SA-6.

Loadout

Enfield 1-1 (lead, backup SEAD and DEAD): 2× AGM-88C HARM, 2× GBU-12, 2× Mk-20 Rockeye, LITENING, 2× AIM-9X, AIM-120C, tank. Enfield 1-2 (strike): 4× Mk-20 Rockeye, 2× GBU-12, LITENING, 2× AIM-9X, AIM-120C, tank.

Station	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1-1	AIM-9X	AGM-88C HARM	2 x GBU-12	LITENING pod	FPU-8A tank 330 gal	AIM-120C	2 x Mk-20 Rockeye	AGM-88C HARM	AIM-9X
1-2	AIM-9X	Mk-20 Rockeye	2 x GBU-12	LITENING pod	FPU-8A tank 330 gal	AIM-120C	2 x Mk-20 Rockeye	Mk-20 Rockeye	AIM-9X

Comms and navigation

Callsign	Role	Frequency	Notes
MOTHER	CVN-74 John C. Stennis	127.5 AM	TACAN 74X STN · ICLS 11
ENFIELD 1-1, 1-2	You	251.0 AM	Flight frequency, shared with ARCO
ARCO	S-3B tanker, 15,000 ft	251.0 AM	TACAN 60Y
MAGIC	E-2C, controls CHEVY and UZI	255.0 AM	
PONTIAC	MQ-9 over the column, laser	F10 menu	Laser 1688
COLT	2× F/A-18C, 4 HARMs each (AI)	F10 push	Holds west of MAGNUM
CHEVY	2× F/A-18C CAP, 20,000 ft	MAGIC commits	Fleet defence comes first
UZI	2× F/A-18C alert-5 on Mother	Via MAGIC	About 12 min to the CAP station

F10 radio menu: Long Road

Item	What it does
Pontiac: target update	Column and SA-6 status and coordinates; when the column moves
PUSH COLT (SEAD)	Sends COLT at the Straight Flush. Once only

Item	What it does
Request CAP cover	Asks MAGIC for CHEVY over the column. Approved only if CHEVY is free
Pontiac laser > Straight Flush, column, terminate	PONTIAC's laser, code 1688
Enfield 1-x > IN on SA-6 radar (DEAD)	Always cleared hot
Enfield 1-x > IN on column	Cleared only inside a suppression window or after DEAD
Enfield 1-x > OFF (request BDA)	BDA for your last pass
Mission summary now	Outcome on demand (automatic once every jet is down)